

Milestone 1 – Idea presentation
Feb 19 Th

If you have formed your group, put your name on the ELMS->People->Group->Semester-long Project

Documentation Due Feb 22 Sun

Groups (15)

▶ Semester long project group 1	0 / 5 students	⋮
▶ Semester long project group 2	0 / 5 students	⋮
▶ Semester long project group 3	0 / 5 students	⋮
▶ Semester long project group 4	0 / 5 students	⋮
▶ Semester long project group 5	0 / 5 students	⋮
▶ Semester long project group 6	0 / 5 students	⋮
▶ Semester long project group 7	0 / 5 students	⋮
▶ Semester long project group 8	0 / 5 students	⋮
▶ Semester long project group 9	0 / 5 students	⋮
▶ Semester long project group 10	0 / 5 students	⋮

5 min presentation + 3 min Q& A

2 Options:

a) Haven't decided on the idea:

Present 3 of your best ideas and explain to us with sketches

b) Know what to do:

Present your final idea – what are the functions, challenges and potential solutions

5 min presentation + 3 min Q& A

Submit a google doc with:

- a) Problem Statement & Idea
- b) System Block Diagram
- c) Input/Sensing + Output/Actuation
- d) Challenges + Potential Solutions
- e) Bill of Materials(BOM)



Braille Label Bot

Huaishu



Perkins SMART Braille



\$ 2K+

6 Dot Braille Label Maker



\$ 775

Reizen Braille Labeler



\$ 40+
But fully manual
Hard to use

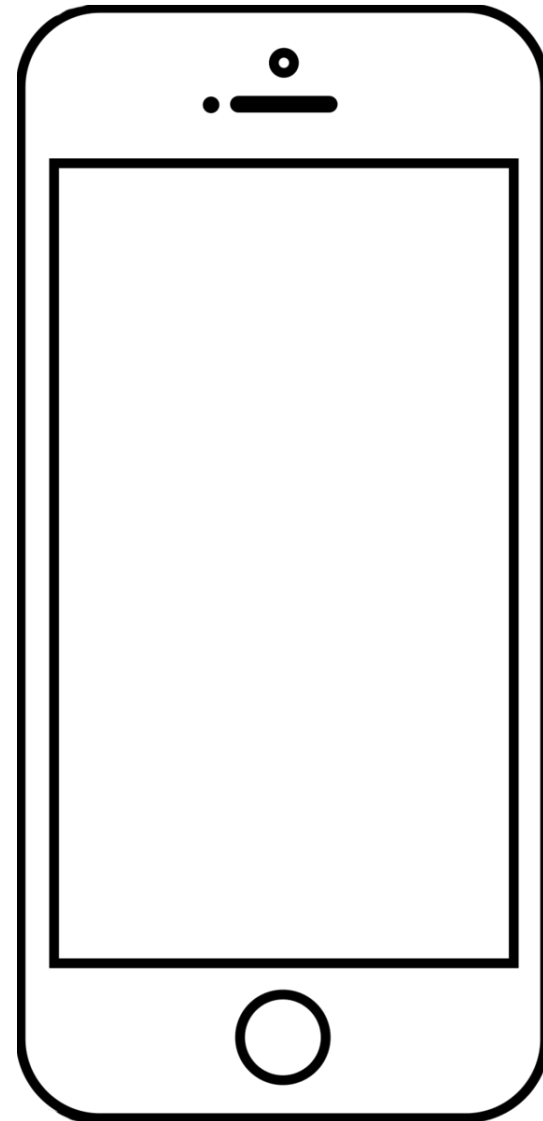
The idea

Low-cost, portable braille label bot that can be used by everyone

Can be used both
Indoor and outdoor

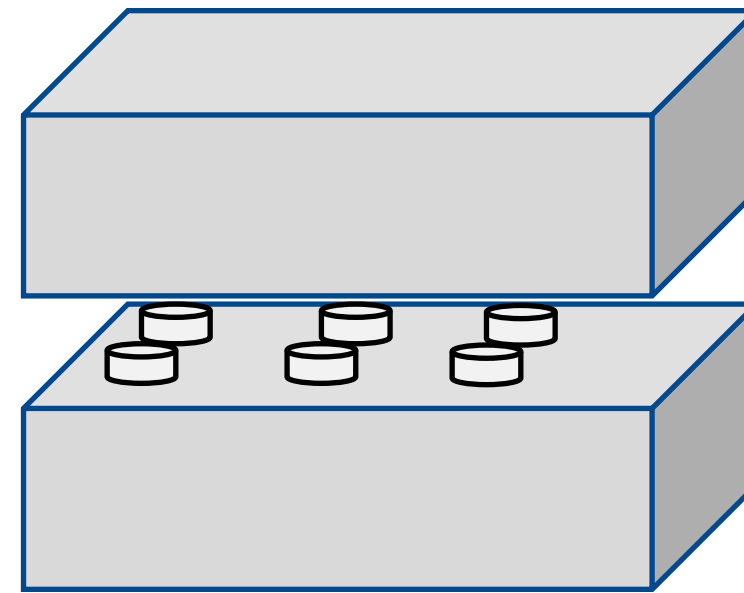
We can create braille
label for them

How



input platform
Either voice or type

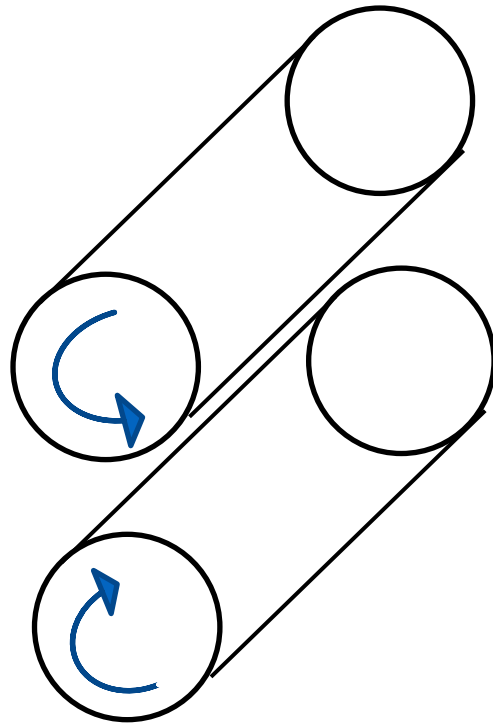
+



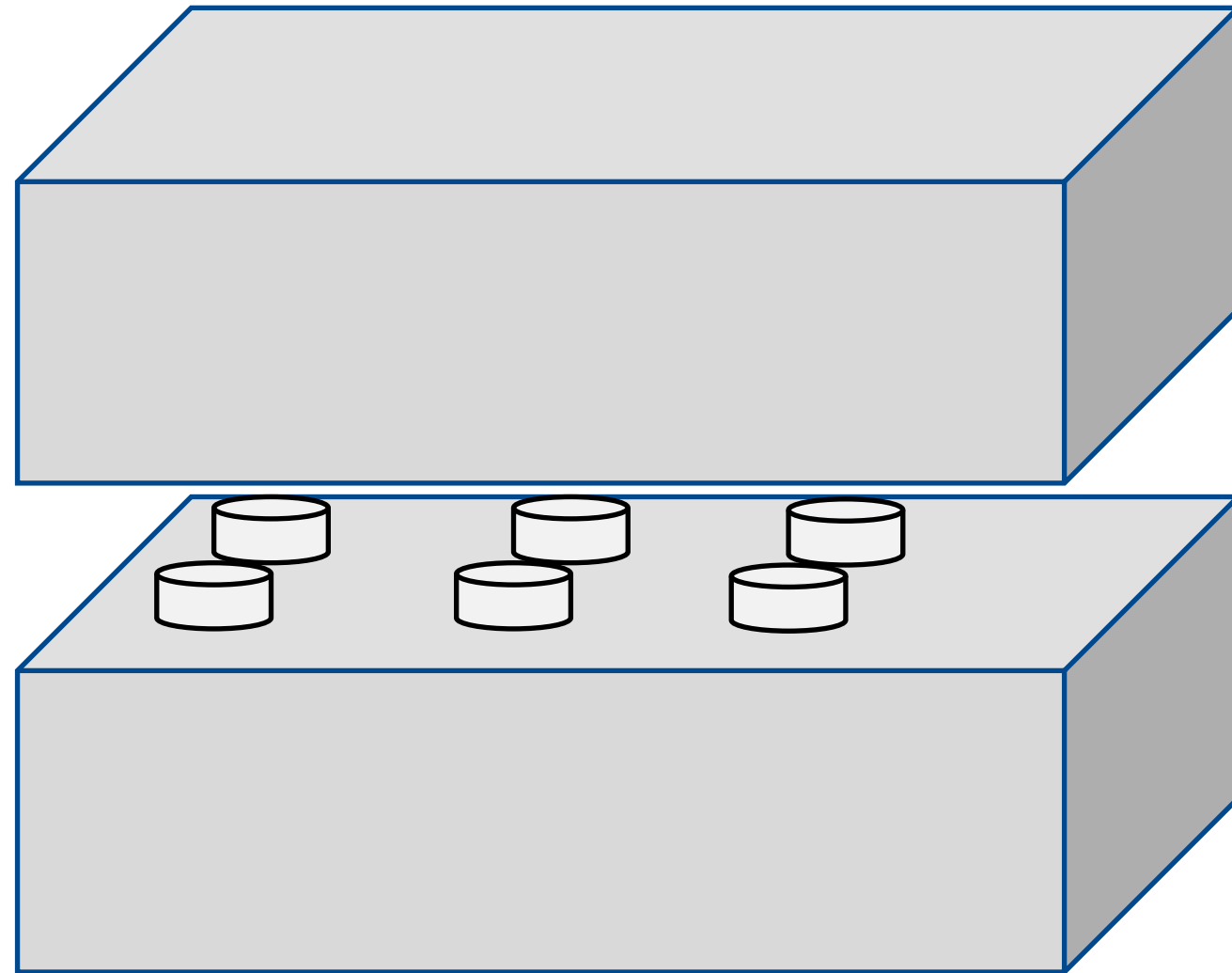
custom build machine
6 pin controlled with Arduino
punch holes to tape



How

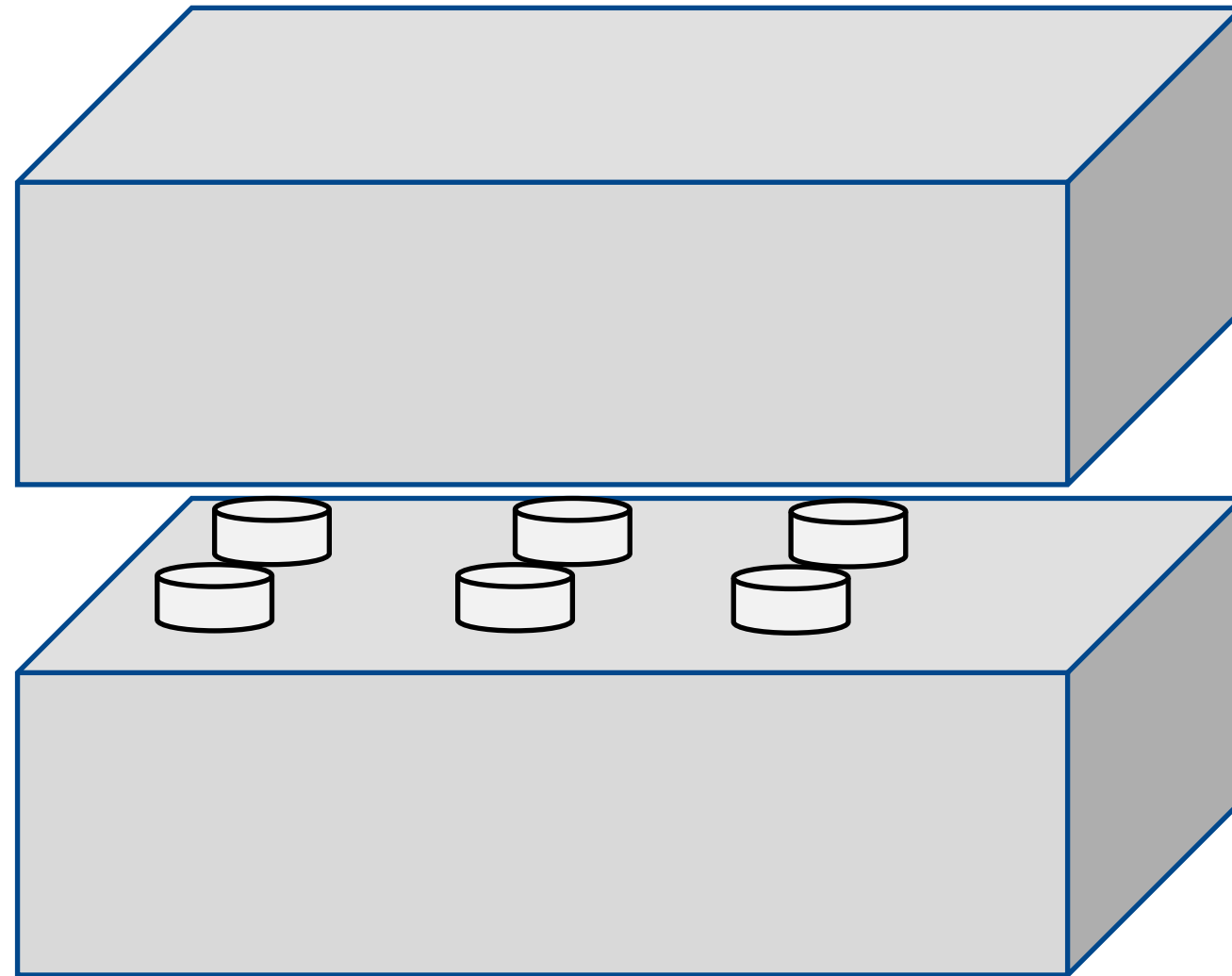


Tape feeder



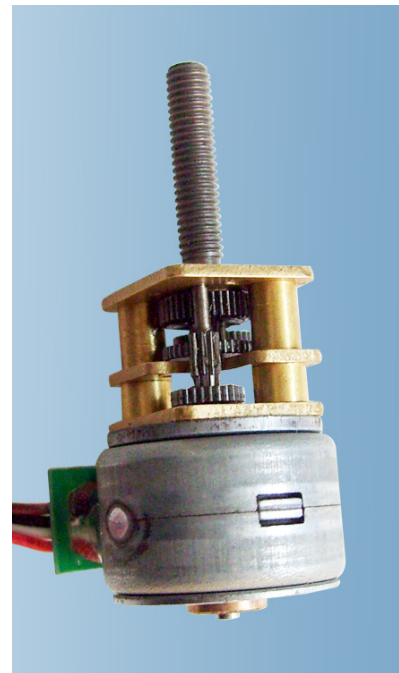
Punch mechanism

Main challenge



1. Limited physical space, dots need to be close to each other – how to arrange motors to control each of the 6 pins
2. Need large force to create hole or embossing

Potential solutions



Plan for the next milestone

1. Figure out the motor to create embossing
2. Create one working prototype that can create 2 dots at a close distance

ClawMyDesk

Huaishu



OpenClaw

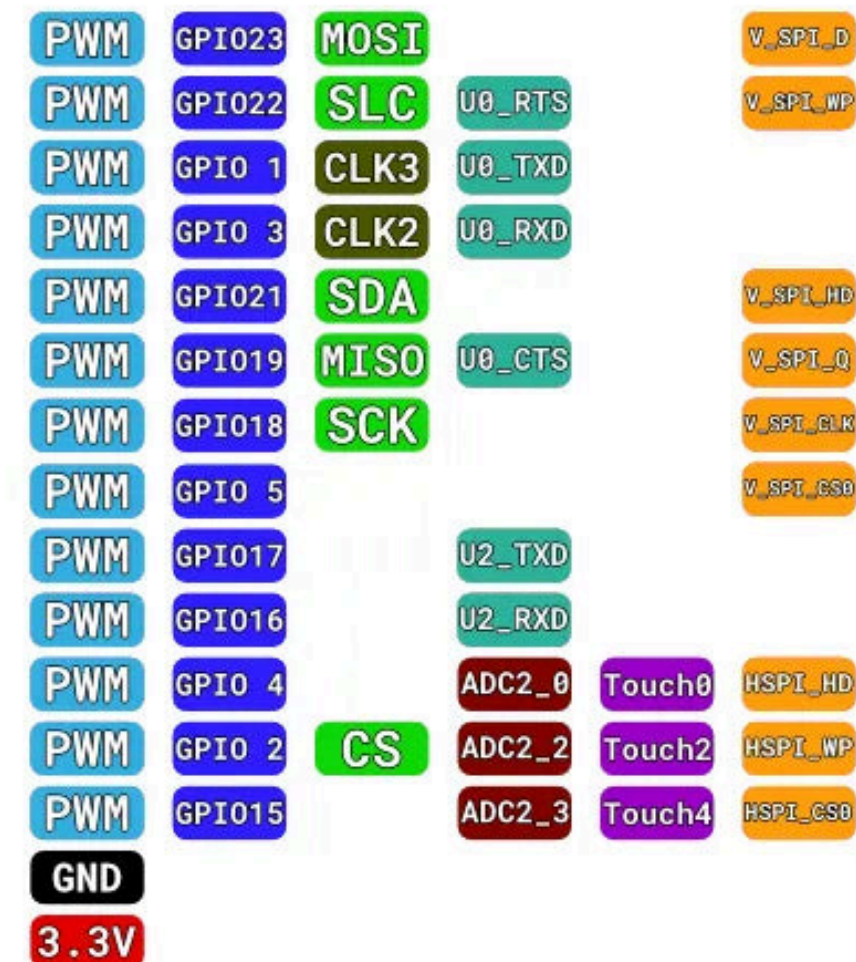
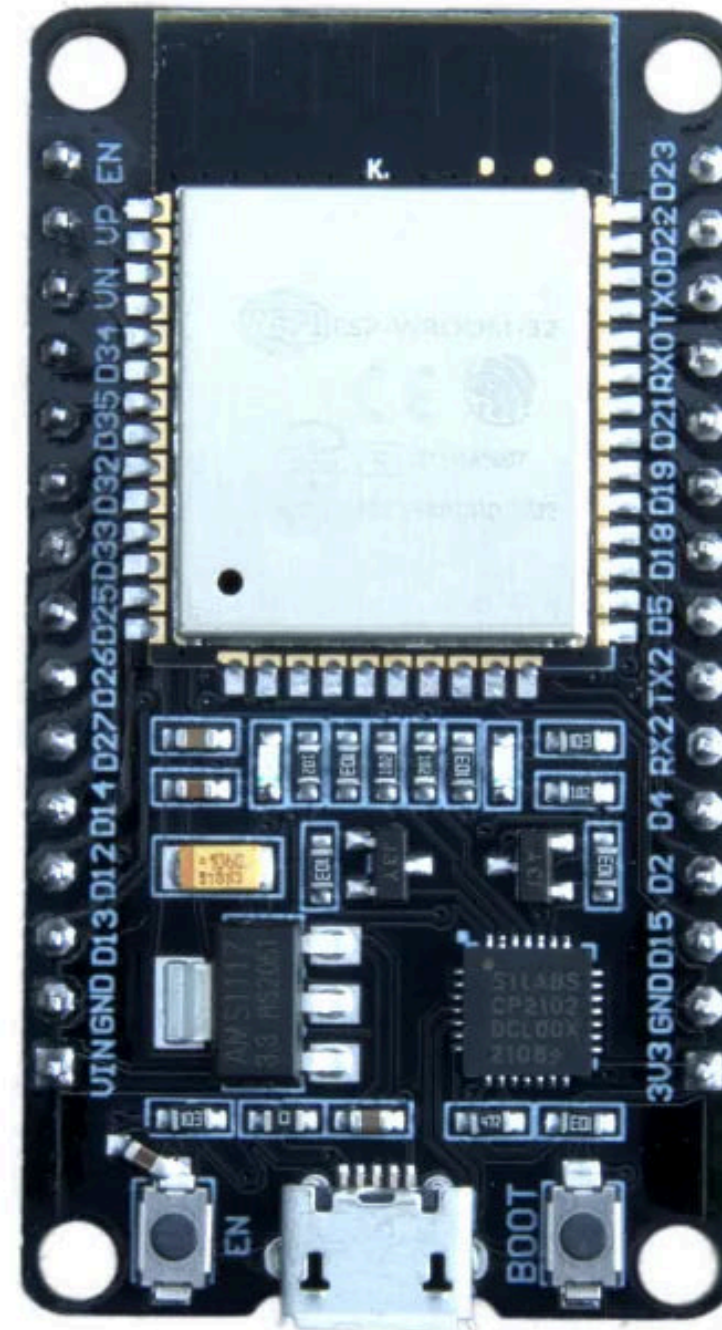
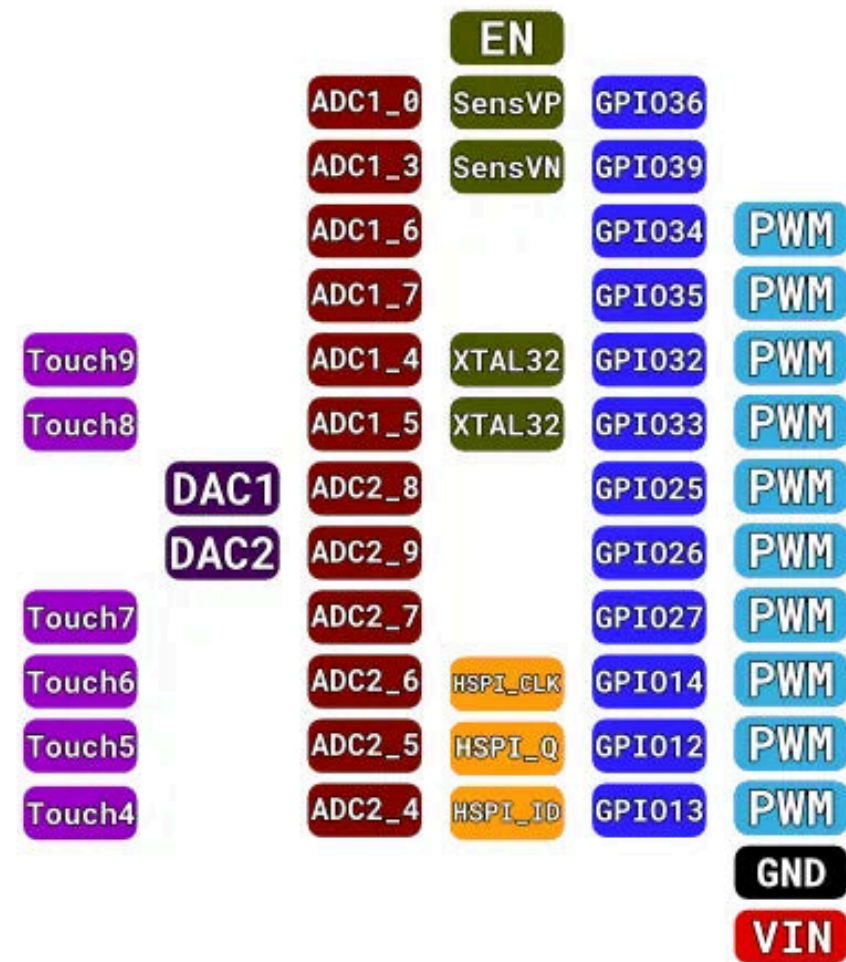


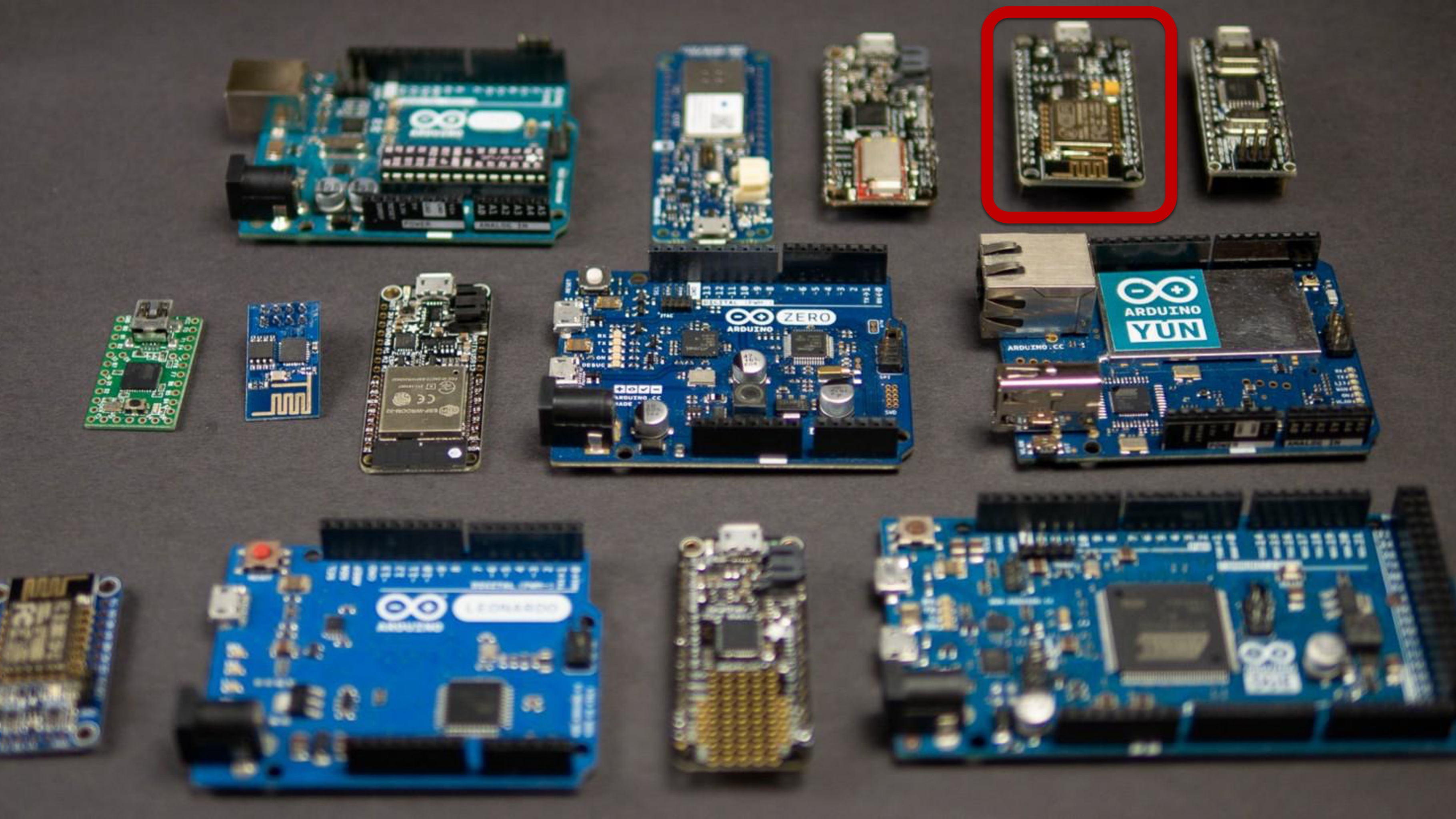
A desktop “claw”bot that can grab things
and cheer me up after every task I complete.

Questions?

DigitalOutput

Huaishu Peng | UMD CS | Spring 2026





What is Arduino?

- 25 GPIO Pins
- 15 ADC-compatible pins
- 21 PWM
- 2 DAC
- 2 I2C

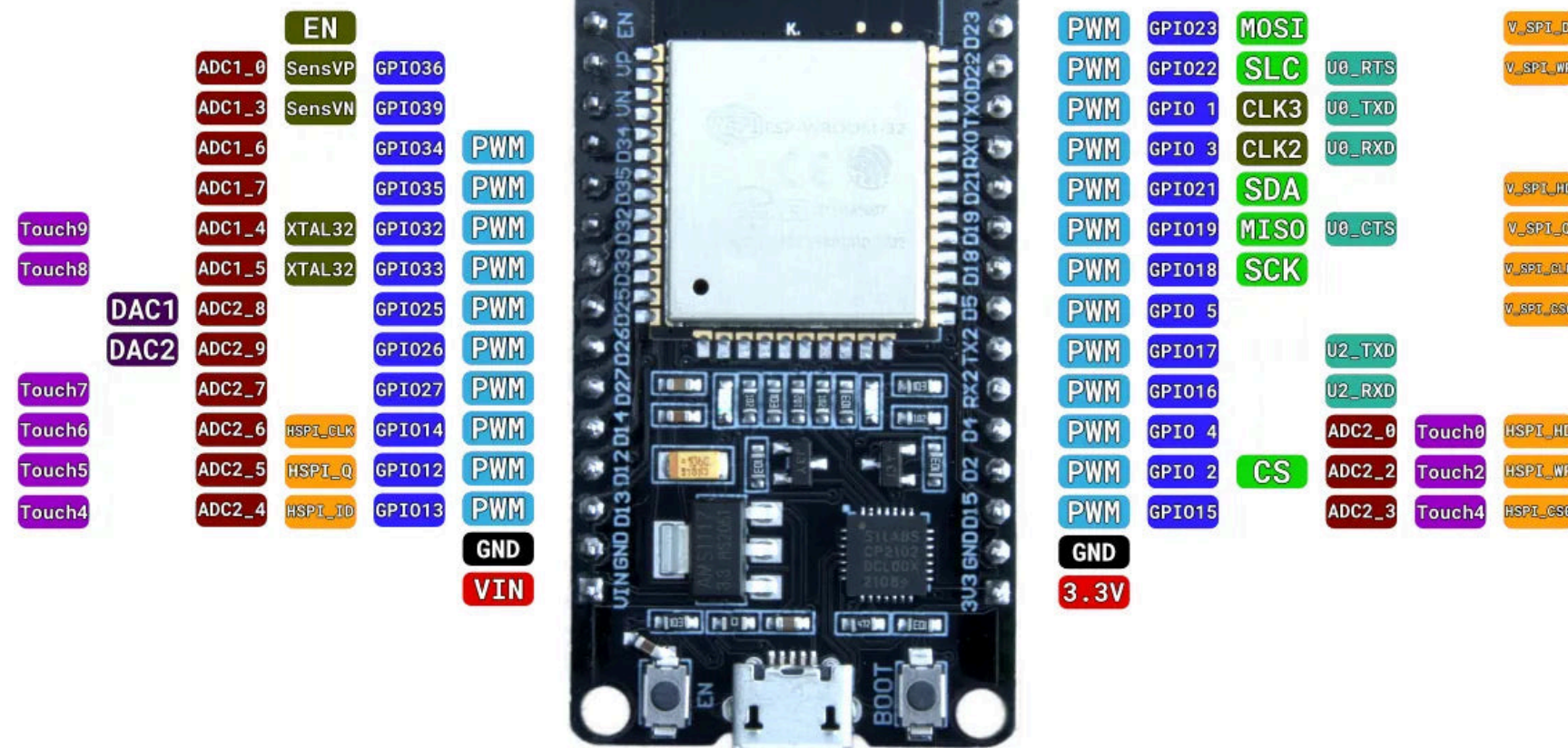
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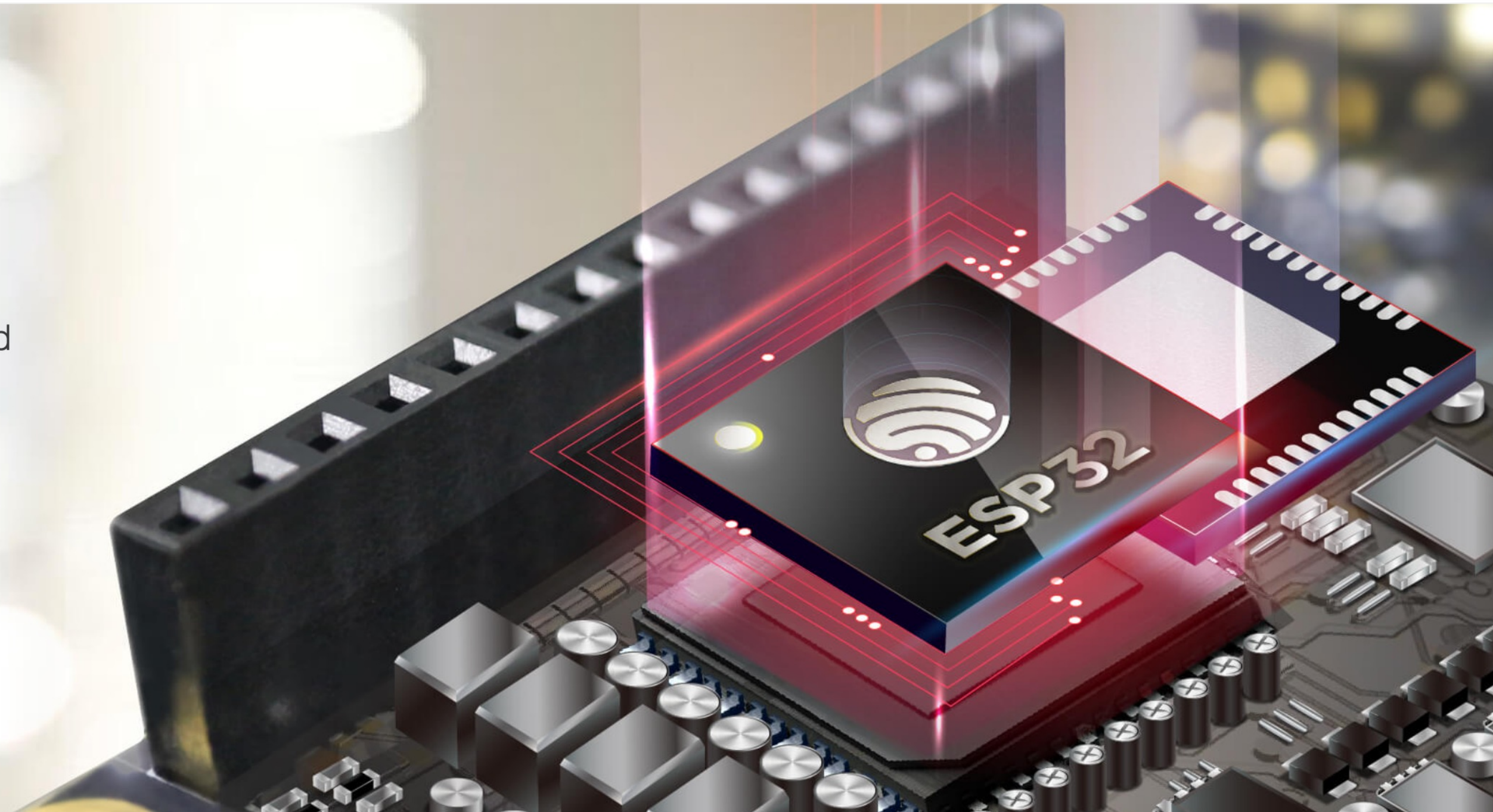
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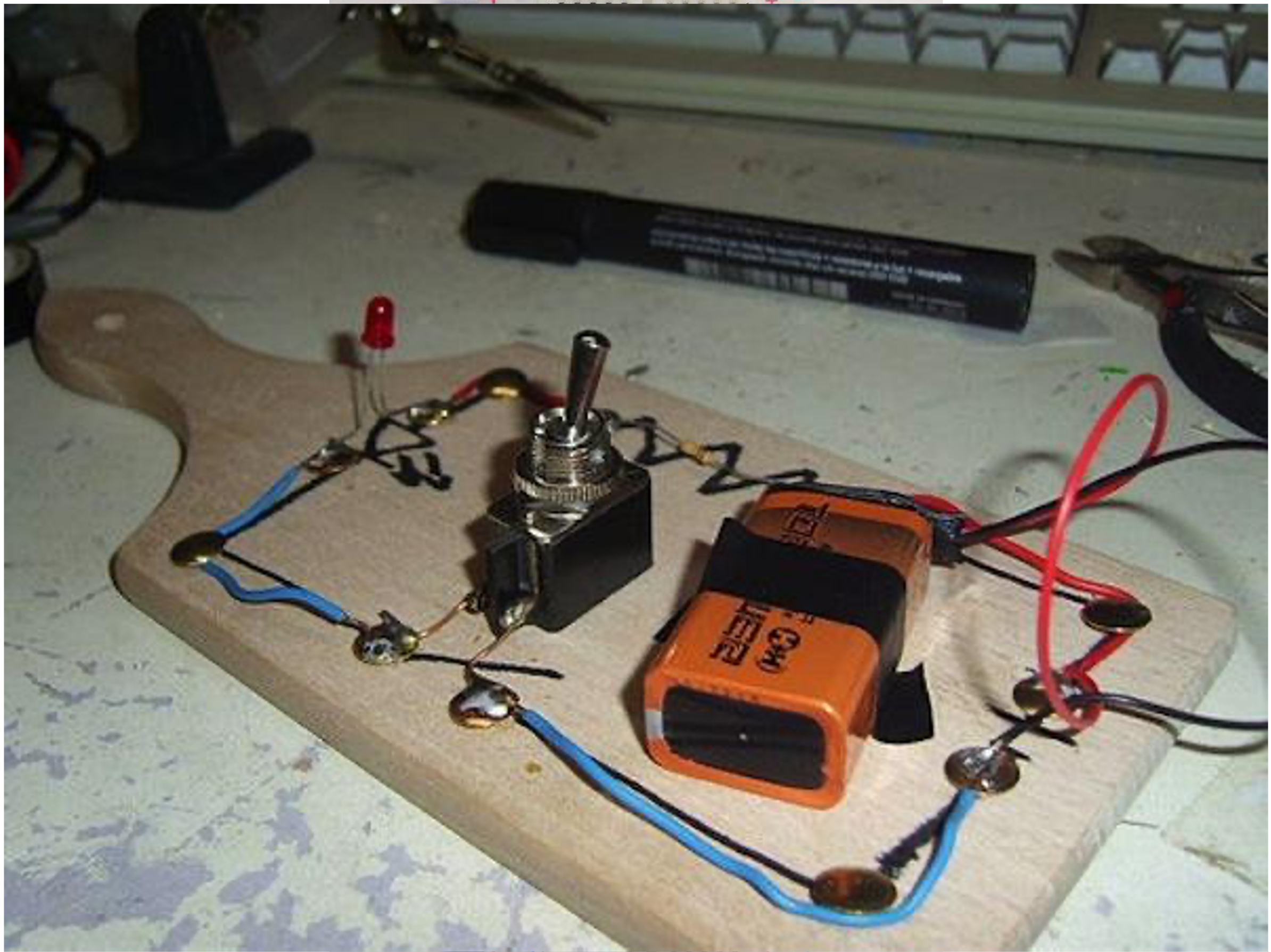
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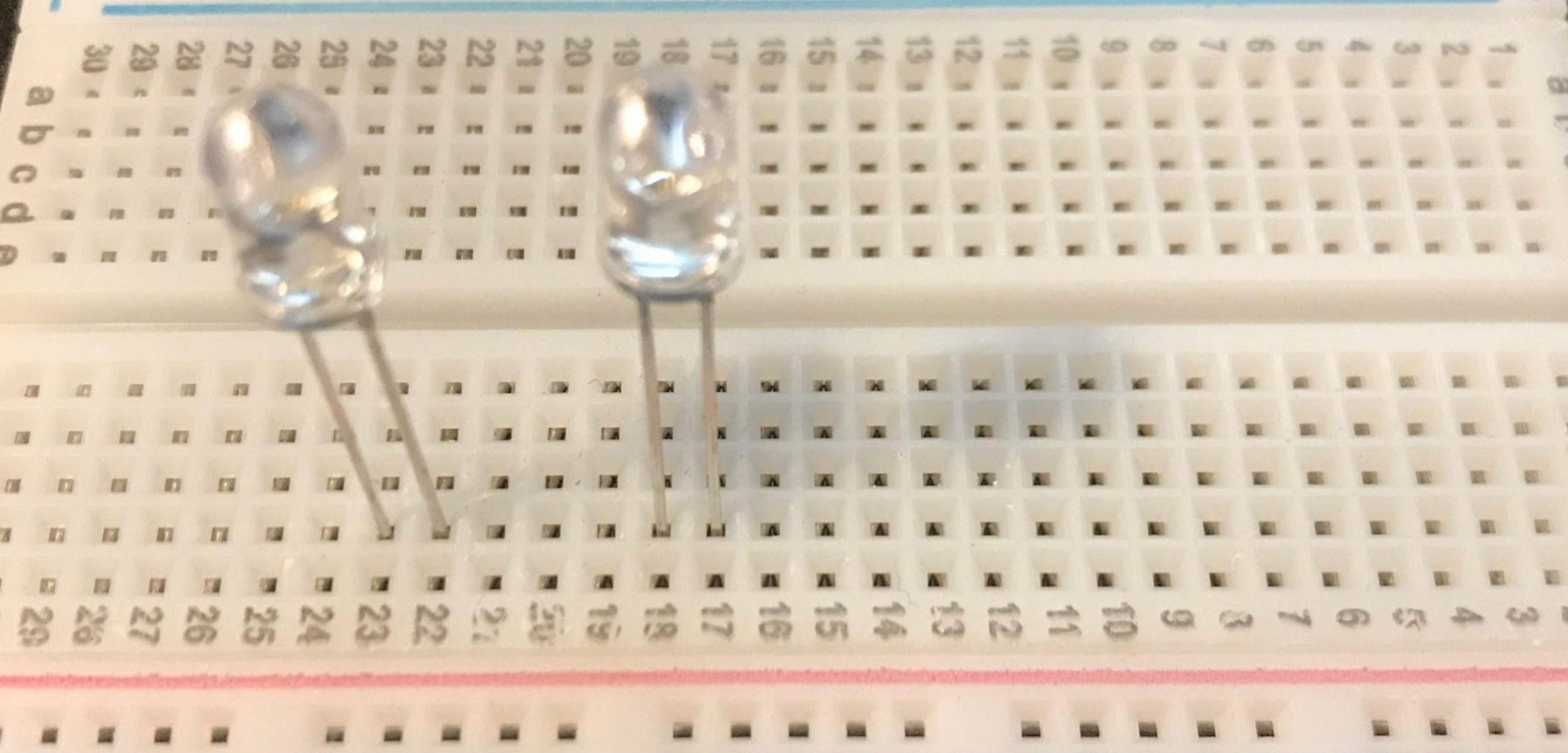


ESP32

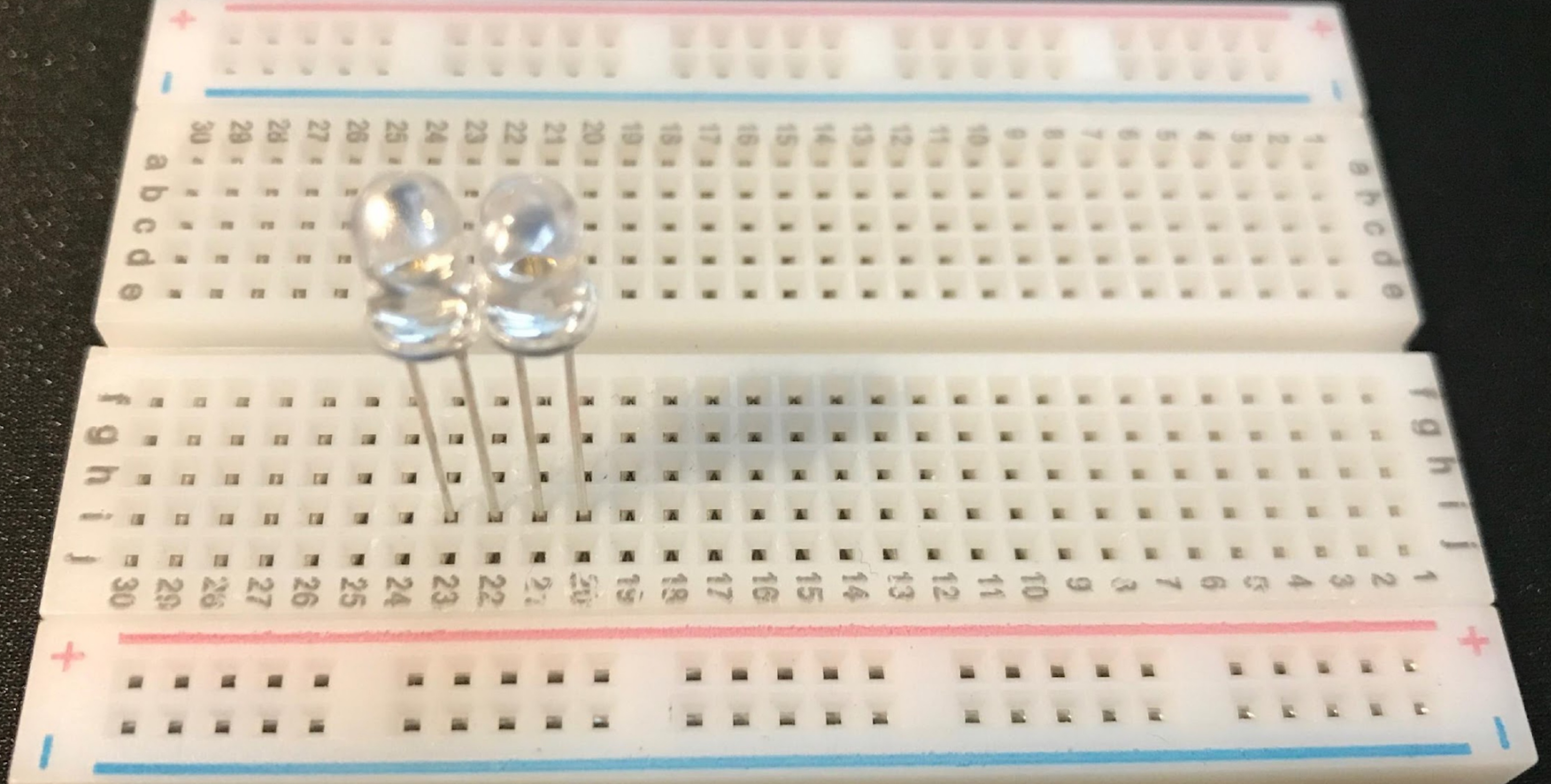
A feature-rich MCU with integrated Wi-Fi and Bluetooth connectivity for a wide-range of applications



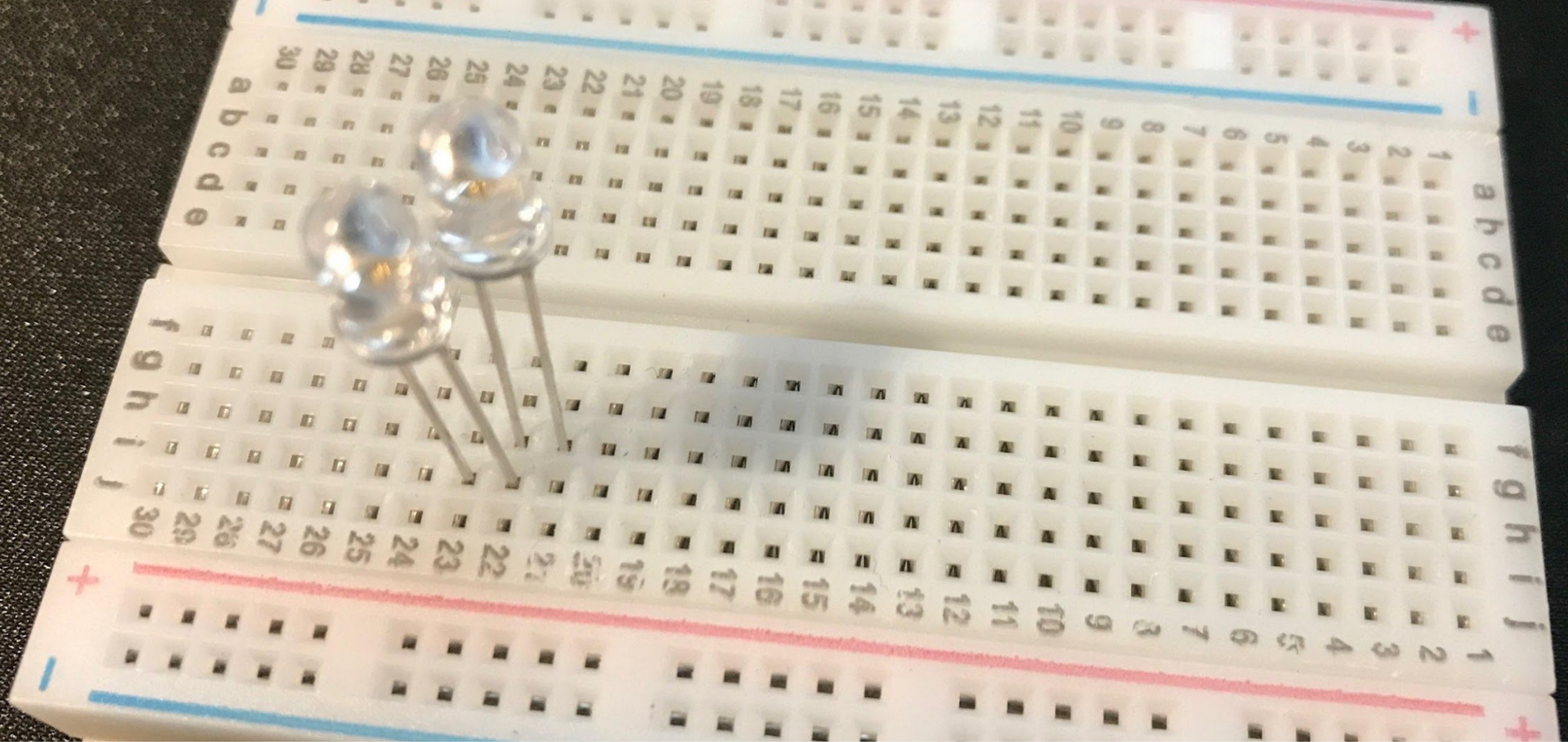




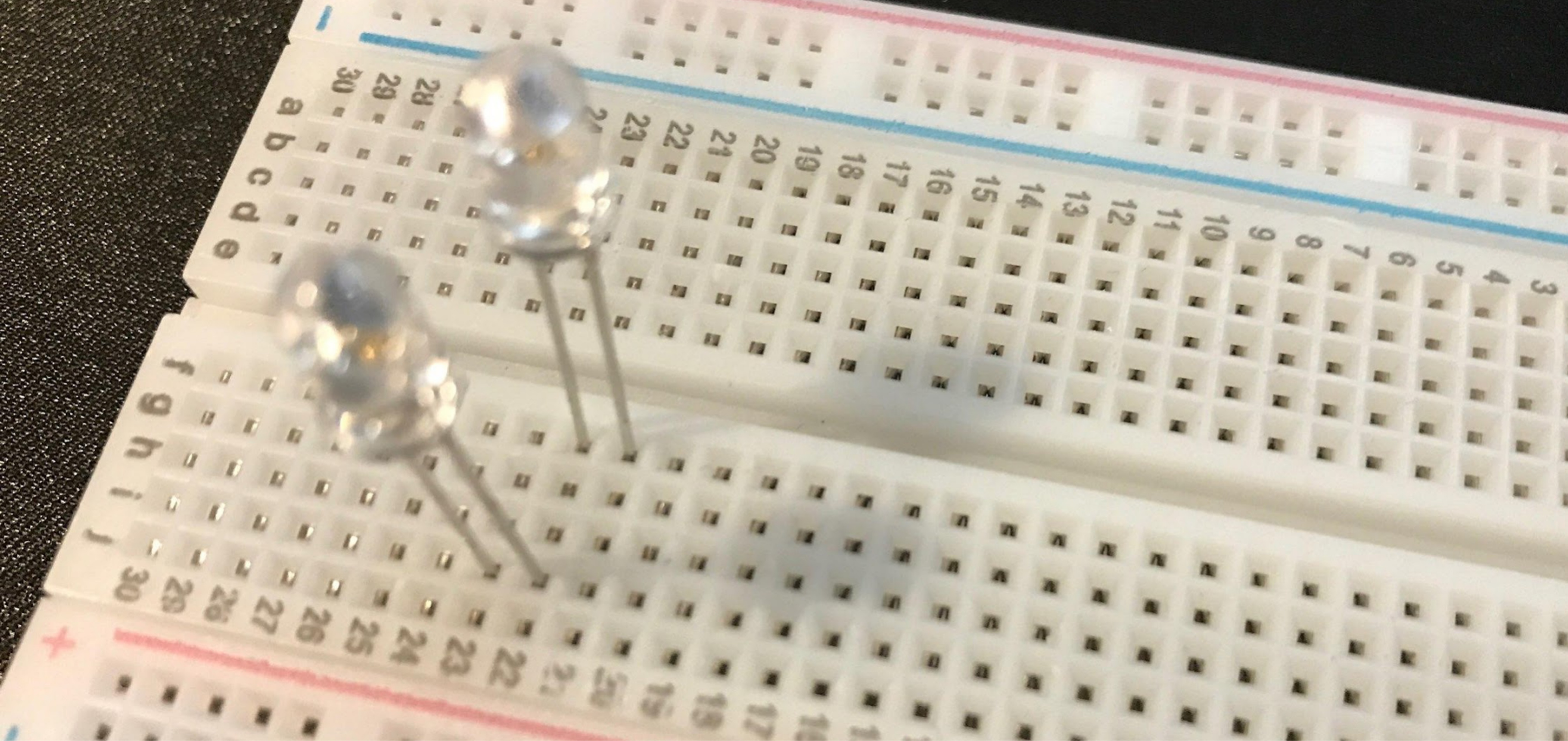
are the LEDs connected with each other?



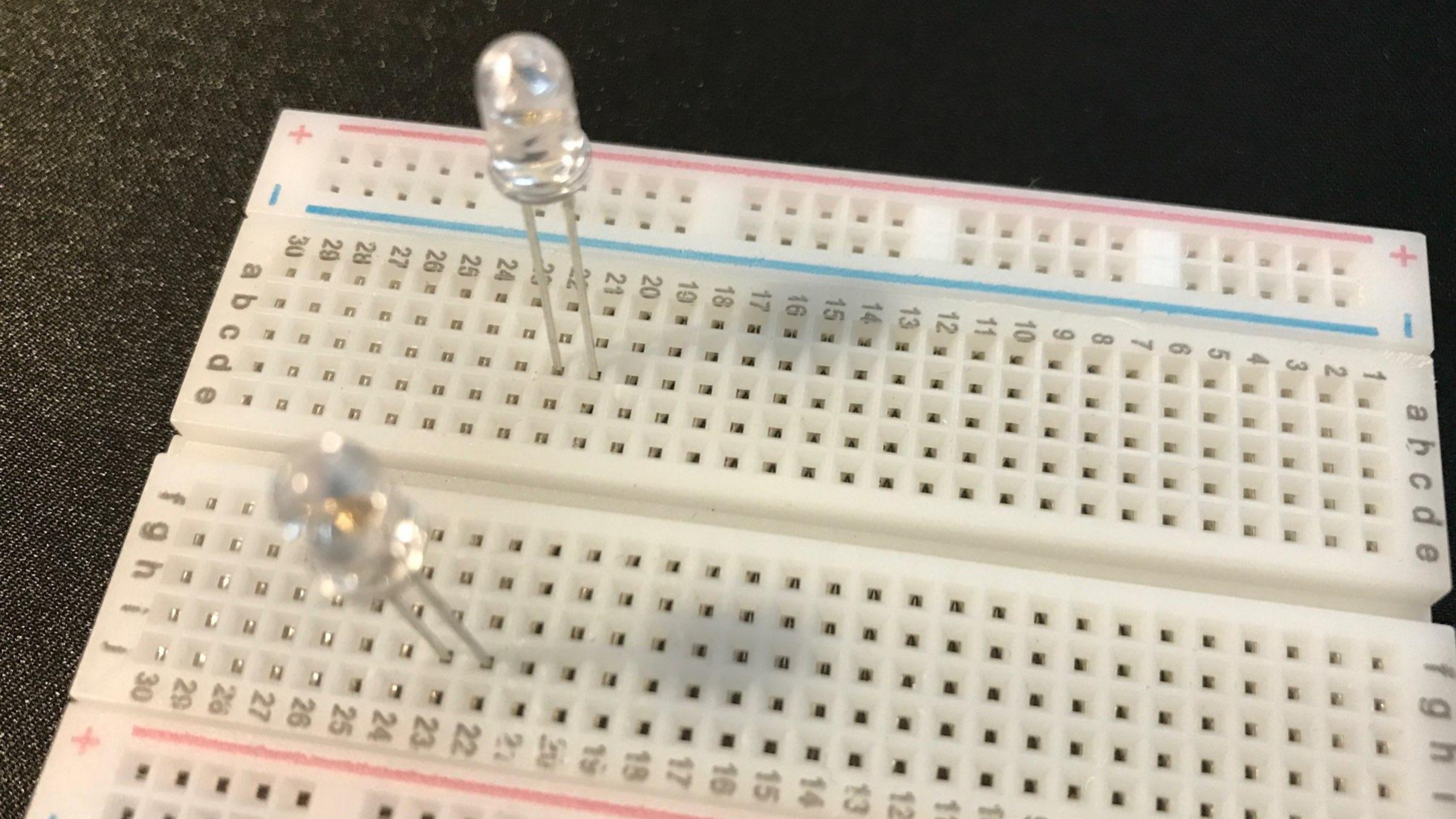
Now?

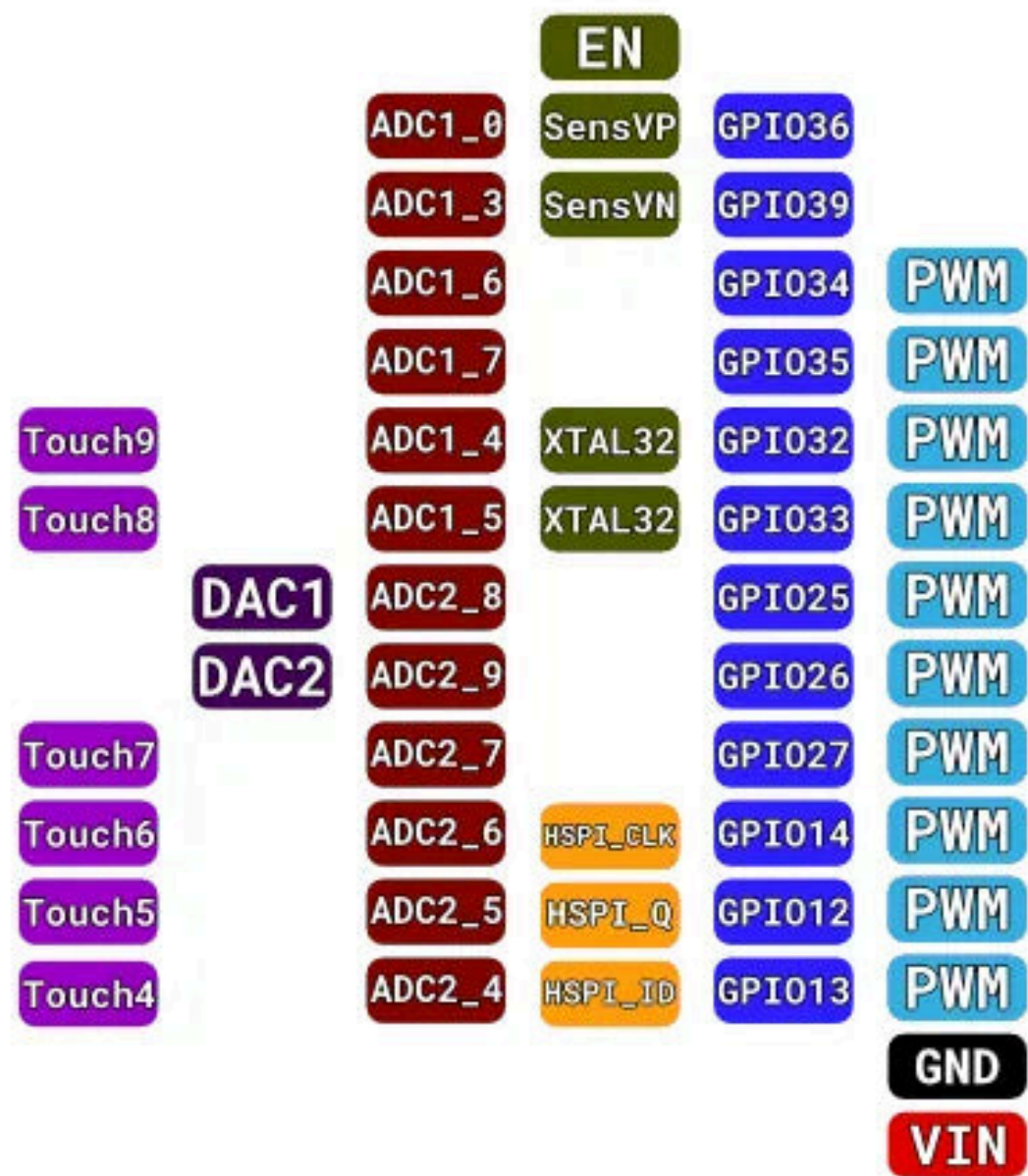


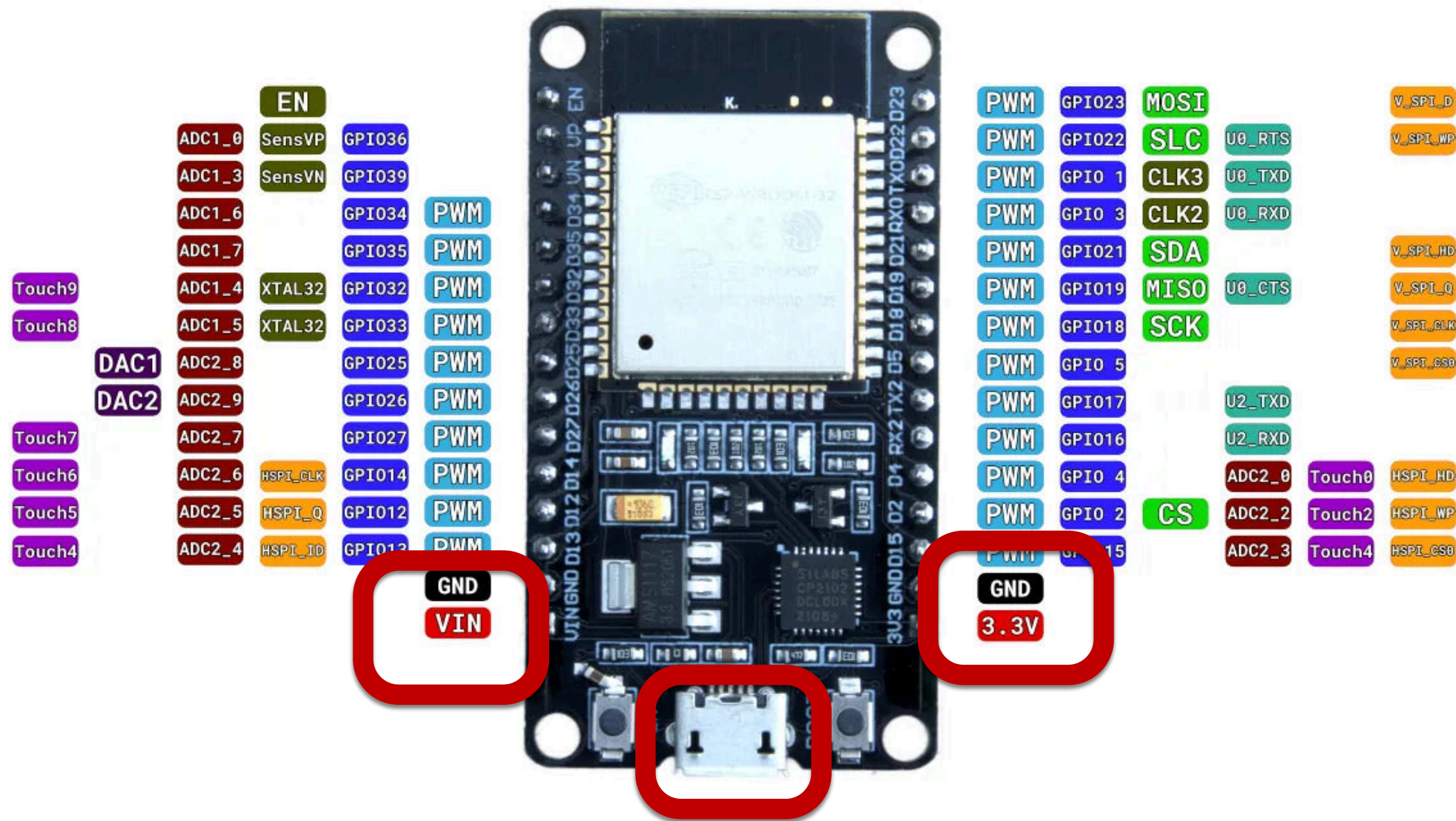
Now?



Now?







3 options to power up ESP32.

1. Directly via USB port.

2. Unregulated power to GND and VIN pins
(Between 5 to 12 v, but 5 if possible)

3. Regulated power to GND and 3.3V pins
(ONLY 3.3v!)

Always only power the microcontroller
with one option

Arduino Framework Basics

EXPLORER

UNTITLED (WORKSPACE)

- TEST PIO
- NodeMCU
- TestCode
- DigitalIO
 - .pio
 - .vscode
 - include
 - lib
 - src
 - main.cpp
- test
- .gitignore
- platformio.ini

OUTLINE

- myFunction(int, int) declaration
- setup()
- loop()
- myFunction(int, int)

TIMELINE

main.cpp TestCode · src

main.cpp DigitalIO · src

DigitalIO > src > main.cpp > ...

```
1  #include <Arduino.h>
2
3  // put function declarations here:
4  int myFunction(int, int);
5
6  void setup() {
7      // put your setup code here, to run once:
8      int result = myFunction(2, 3);
9  }
10
11 void loop() {
12     // put your main code here, to run repeatedly:
13 }
14
15 // put function definitions here:
16 int myFunction(int x, int y) {
17     return x + y;
18 }
```

PROBLEMS

OUTPUT

DEBUG CONSOLE

TERMINAL

PORTS

zsh - TestCode

huaishu@INFO TestCode %

Ln 1, Col 1

Spaces: 2

UTF-8

LF

{ } C++

PlatformIO

Digital Output – Blink an LED

Digital Output

Set the logic value of a pin

– LOW (0V) or HIGH (3.3V)

Arduino functions

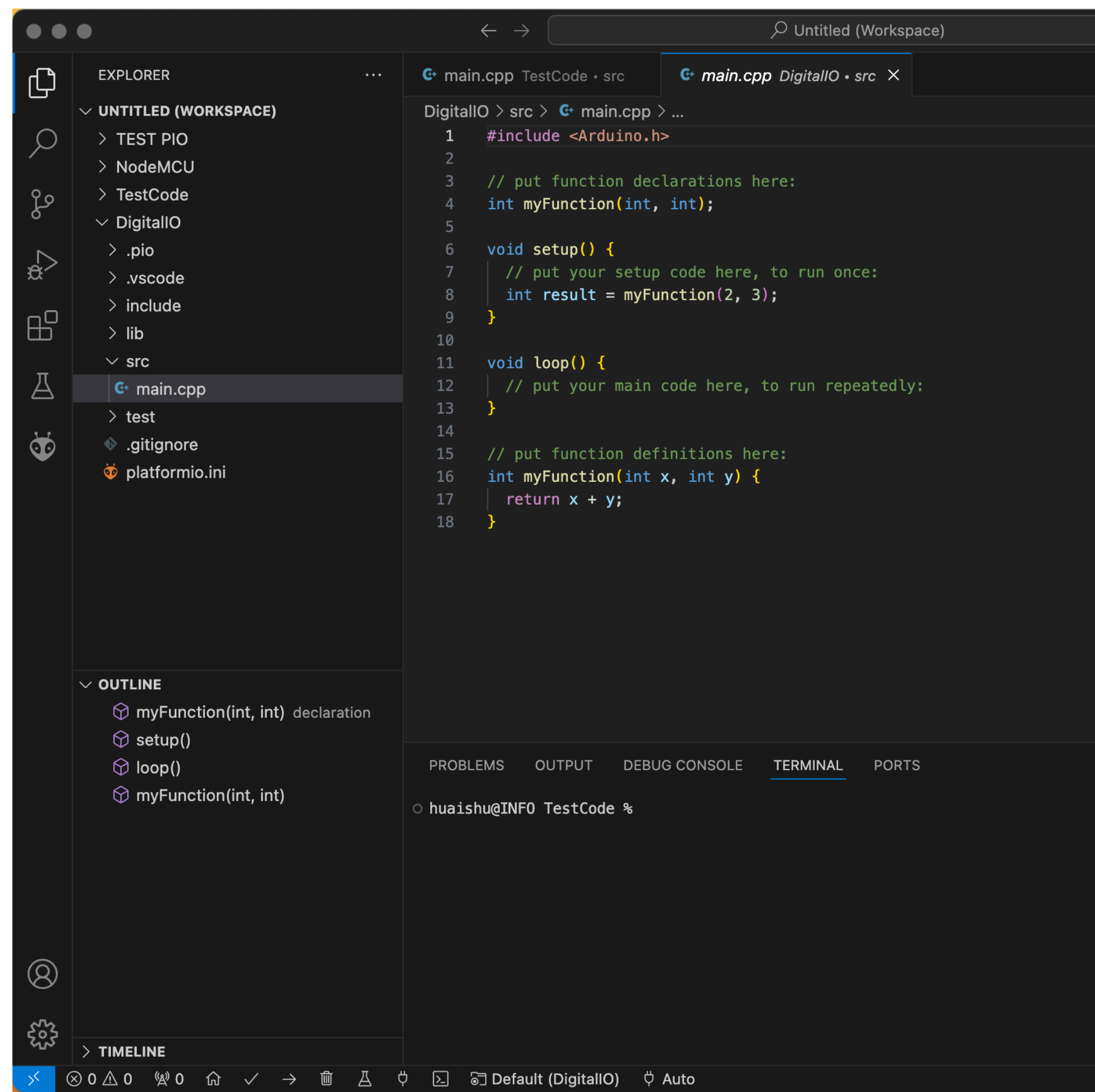
– pinMode(pin, OUTPUT) to set the pin direction

Often in the setup() function

– digitalWrite(pin, value) to write the current value of a pin

Limitations

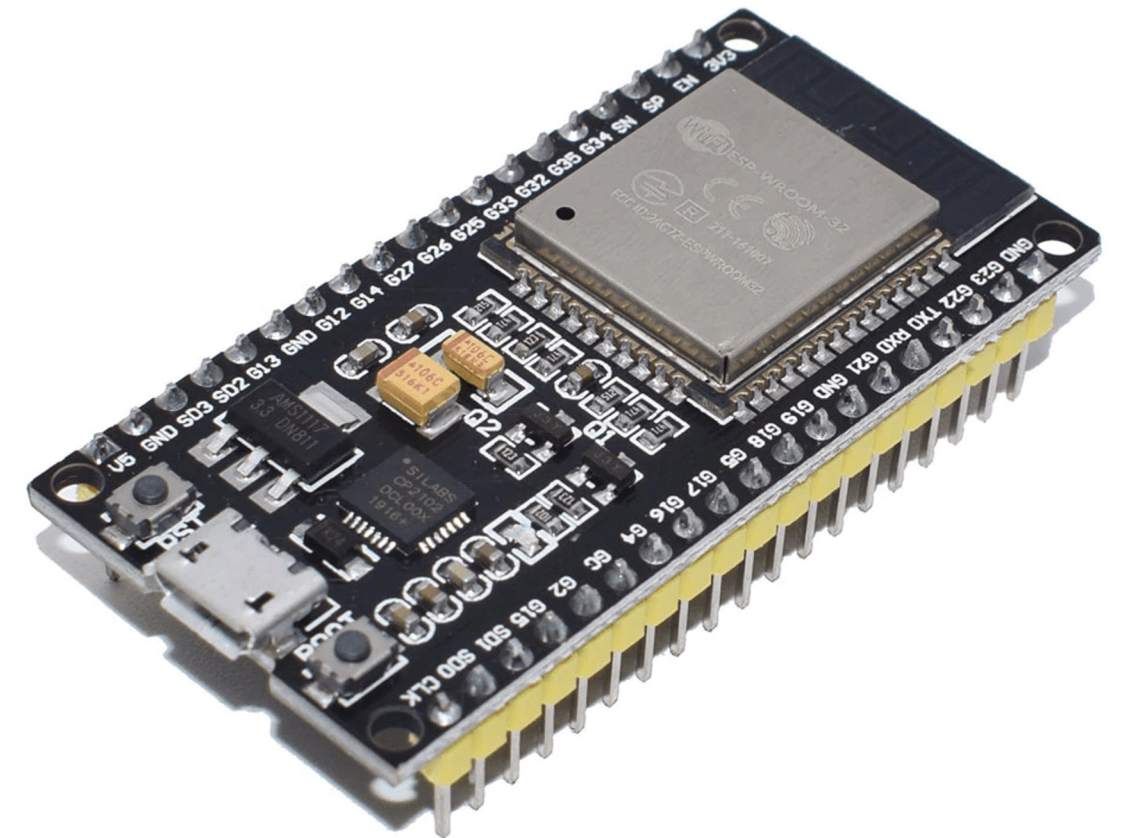
– Only 0 or 3.3 V with limited current;



Blink the built-in LED

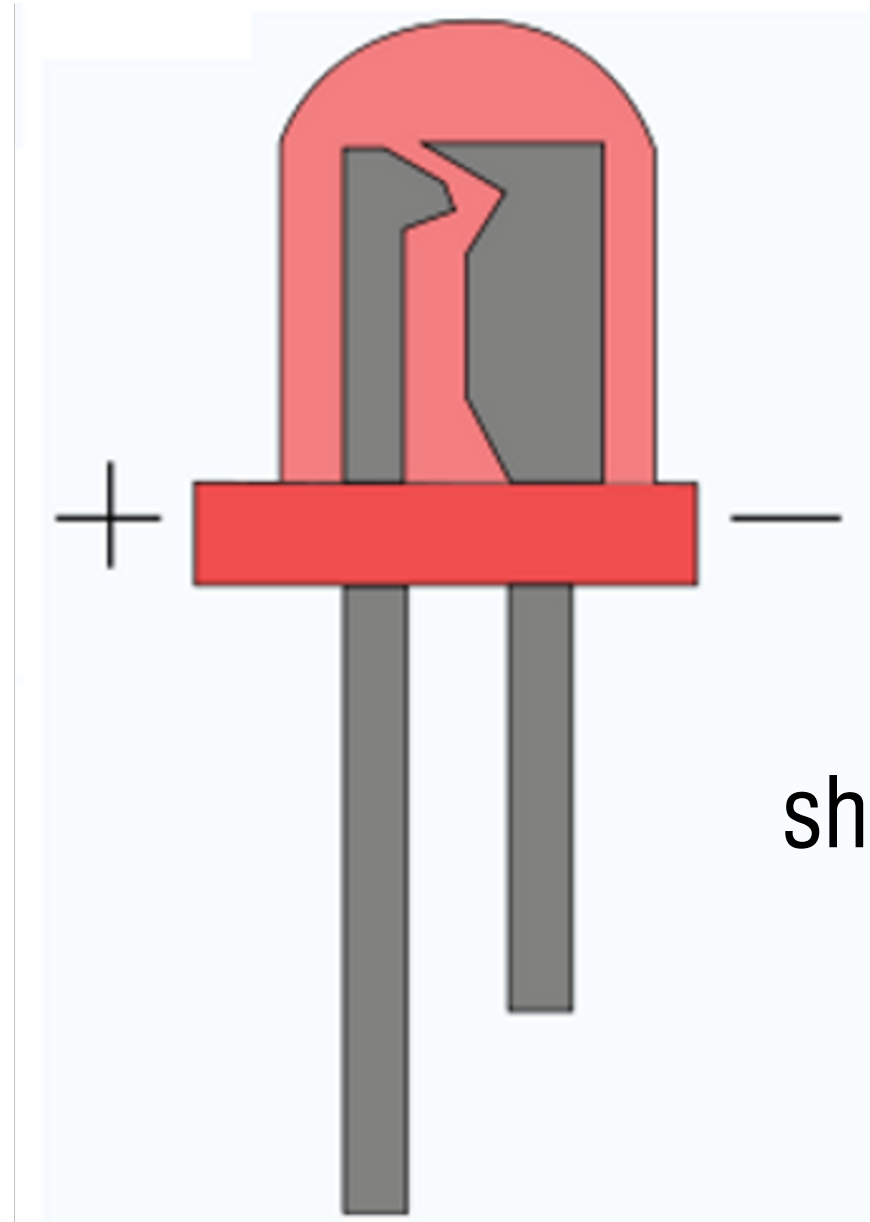
```
#include <Arduino.h>
```

```
// constants definition
const int ledPin = 2; // Default LED is connected to GPIO 2
// The setup() method runs once, when the sketch starts
void setup() {
  // initialize the digital pin as an output:
  pinMode(ledPin, OUTPUT);
}
// the loop() method runs over and over again,
// as long as the Arduino has power
void loop()
{
  digitalWrite(ledPin, HIGH); // set the LED on
  delay(5000); // wait for 5 second
  digitalWrite(ledPin, LOW); // set the LED off
  delay(5000); // wait for 5 second
}
```



Practice: Light up an RED Led

long leg



short leg

Blink an external LED

```
#include <Arduino.h>
```

```
// constants definition
```

```
const int ledPin = 27; // Default LED is connected to GPIO 27
```

```
// The setup() method runs once, when the sketch starts
```

```
void setup() {
```

```
    // initialize the digital pin as an output:
```

```
    pinMode(ledPin, OUTPUT);
```

```
}
```

```
// the loop() method runs over and over again,
```

```
// as long as the Arduino has power
```

```
void loop()
```

```
{
```

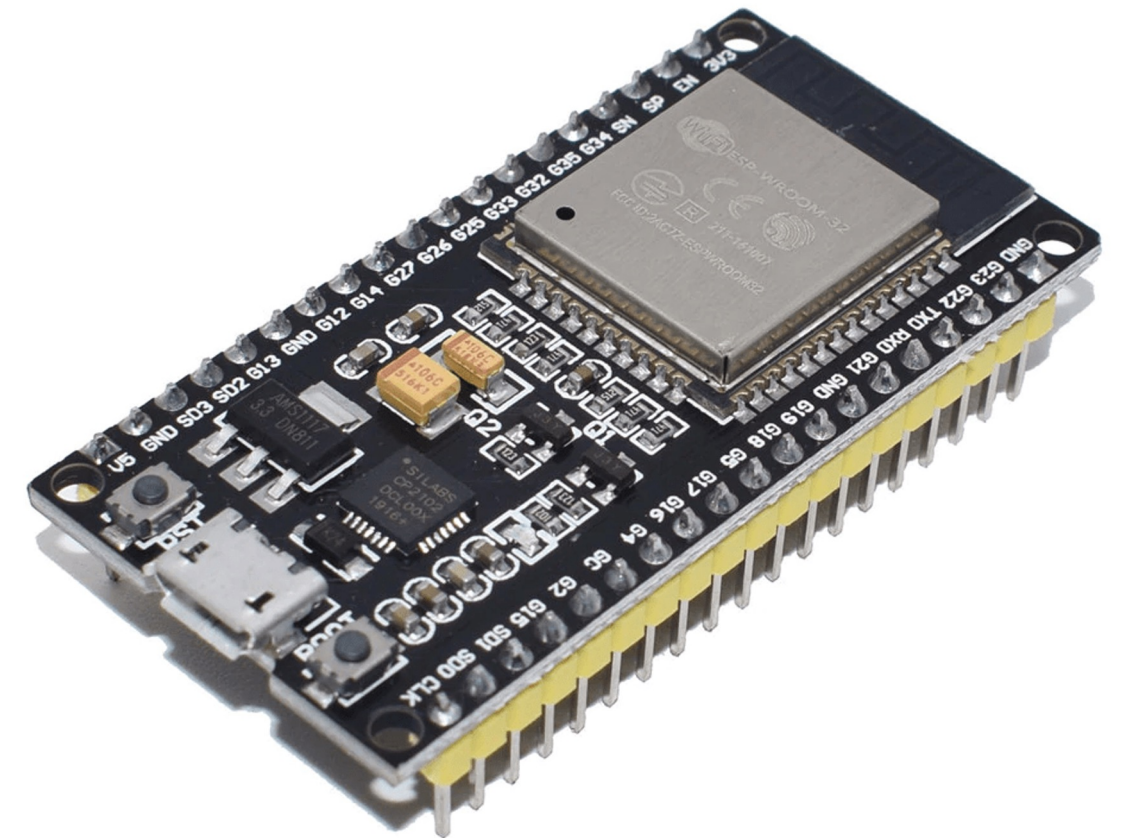
```
    digitalWrite(ledPin, HIGH); // set the LED on
```

```
    delay(5000); // wait for 5 second
```

```
    digitalWrite(ledPin, LOW); // set the LED off
```

```
    delay(5000); // wait for 5 second
```

```
}
```



Serial Communication – talk to PC

Serial Communication

Setup

- `Serial.begin(<baud_speed>)//9600`

Receiving information

- Test if data is available
 `Serial.available()`
- Read one byte
 `Serial.read()`

Sending information

- Raw data transfer
 `Serial.write(val)` or `Serial.write(buf, len)`

Other commands -> <https://www.arduino.cc/reference/en>

- Formatted output

`Serial.print(x, {BIN, OCT, DEC, HEX})`

- Read formatted data

`Serial.parseFloat()`

`Serial.parseInt()`

Echo program

// setup performs initializations

void setup()

{

 // initialize the serial port setting its speed to 9600 Baud:

 Serial.begin(9600);

}

// the loop() method runs over and over again,

// as long as the Arduino has power

void loop() {

 if (Serial.available() > 0) {

 // Read the incoming byte

 char incomingByte = Serial.read();

 Serial.print("You entered: ");

 Serial.println(incomingByte);

 }

}

Assignment

Morse code

– Input:

3451 from the Serial Terminal

Monitor

– Output:

Blink the LED accordingly

International Morse code



For this assignment:

A dot is 100ms long

A dash is equal to 3 dots

A space between parts of the same letter is equal to one dot

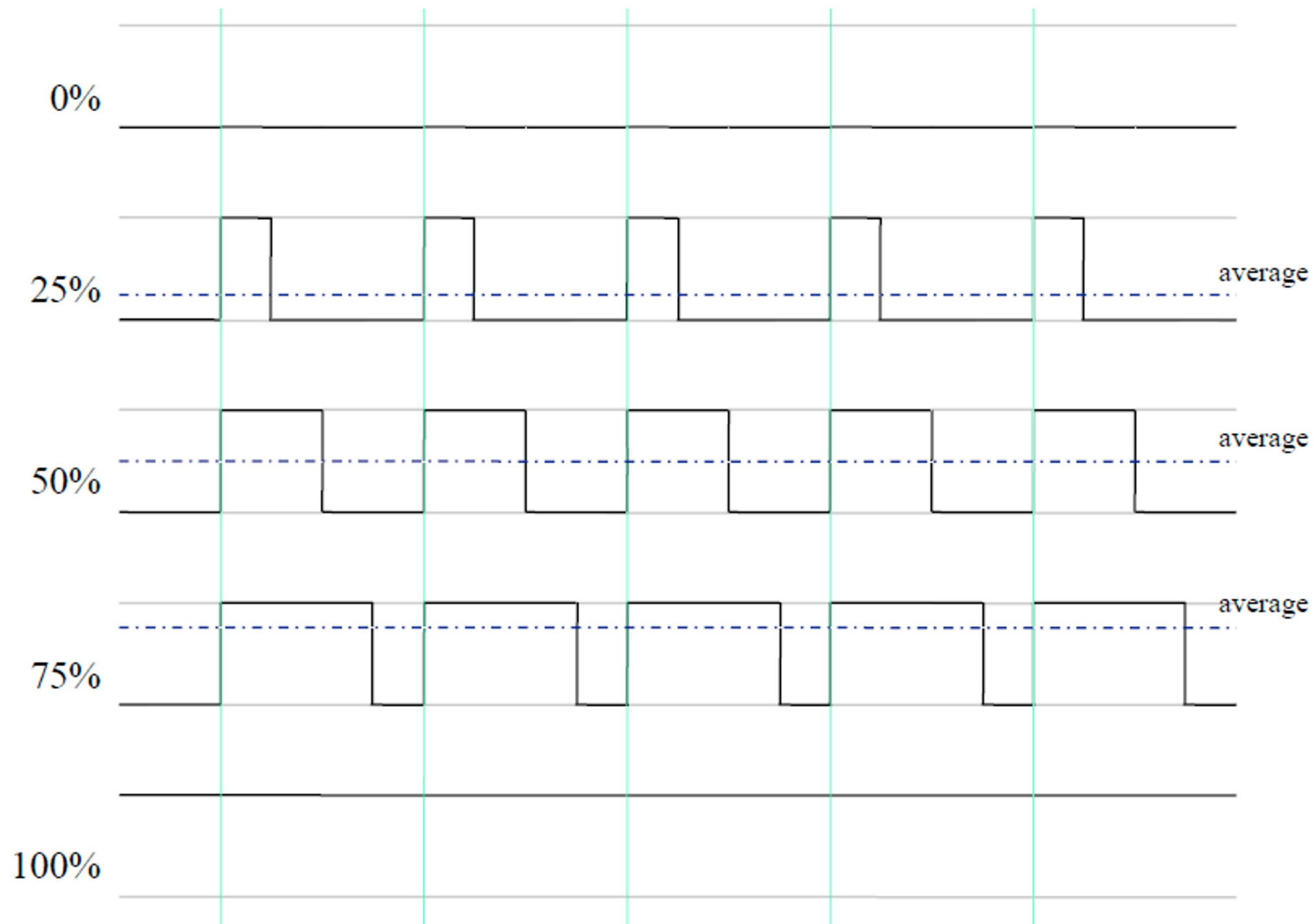
The space between two letters is equal to three dots

Submission:

Unlisted YouTube video link for the blinking LED

Upload the Arduino code

Pulse Width Modulation (PWM)



analogWrite() is on a scale of 0 - 255

Now modify your program to

blink the LED with 100% light intensity
when type '1' from the PC

turn it off when type '0'

light up with 50% light intensity when
type '2'